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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Democrats seek unity on criminal justice bills

State lawmakers strain to reach consensus on reform legislation

By **Jeremy Gorner**
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — Criminal justice reform has long been one of the most divisive issues between Democrats who control the Illinois General Assembly and the Republican minority.

But it's also created a split between progressive Democrats and party moderates, who walk a fine line as they seek to avoid being labeled as weak on crime during the next election cycle. The intra-party differences have been on display in the final weeks of the spring legislative session as lawmakers have considered bills aimed at giving a chance at freedom to people serving lengthy prison sentences for crimes committed when they were youths and dropping a requirement that inmates serve a significant percentage of their original sentence.

Last month, the divide left House Democrats unable to pass legislation that would have provided additional resentencing options for people convicted of committing crimes when they were under 21. It was a rare instance of a Democratic bill failing after being called to a floor vote.

Democratic State Rep. Justin Slaughter of Chicago, a progressive on criminal justice issues who sponsored the sweeping 2021 criminal justice reforms known as the SAFE-T Act, acknowledged that for the party to be uniformly on board, proposals need to have "the right mix of fairness in the justice system without disturbing the goals of enhancing public safety and ensuring accountability."

"It's always been a tough pull and tug, trying to strike the balance between ... wanting to make sure that you're prioritizing safety, prioritizing accountability, but at the same time creating an environment where you're able to address criminogenic risk behaviors and also address those who may have already touched our system to become rehabilitated," Slaughter said.

Criminal justice is an area where politicians have to tread carefully, said Chicago state Rep. Eva-Dina Delgado, a Democrat from the party's moderate wing.

"I think we have to be thoughtful about how we change the system and make sure that those that are charged with keeping us safe have the tools that they need and at the same time, we are dealing with

Turn to Justice, Page 2

Russia, Ukraine creep toward talks

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said he is hoping for a full, temporary ceasefire Monday, and he would be in Turkey to negotiate with Russian President Vladimir Putin "personally." **Nation & World**



VINCENT D. JOHNSON/
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Van Etten shows growth at Salt Shed

Performing with the Attachment Theory, singer-songwriter presented a more confident, self-assured version of herself. **Arts & Living**



Kat Abughazaleh, who has announced she's running for Illinois' 9th Congressional District next year, chats with Jacob Geittmann, a resident of Buena Park, as they paint a wall in her new campaign office in Rogers Park on Tuesday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Digital creator part of field sure to grow for 9th District

Others expected to challenge young newcomer eyeing Rep. Schakowsky's seat

By **Olivia Olander**
and **Daniel C. Vock**
Chicago Tribune

A day after U.S. Rep. Jan Schakowsky told hundreds of people at a swanky downtown Chicago hotel that she wasn't running for reelection, the first major declared 9th Congressional District candidate sat cross-legged in her new Rogers Park campaign headquarters, painting an image of a lava lamp on the wall.

Kat Abughazaleh, a 26-year-old newcomer to the Chicago region who is banking on her blunt messaging and massive online following to earn her a place on Capitol Hill, might have been the first to announce she was running for the congressional seat — even before the 80-year-old Schakowsky said she wouldn't run again. But Abughazaleh won't be the last.

One state legislator, state Sen. Laura Fine of Glenview, joined the race within hours of Schakowsky's announcement. Other local

politicians are expected to follow soon, setting up a confrontation between candidates employing new media savvy and those relying on grassroots support and old-school organizing.

In the heavily Democratic district, which includes parts of Chicago's Far North Side, as well as north and northwest suburbs from Evanston to Algonquin, the Democratic primary will be the key race in determining who will be only the third representative for the district since 1965.

Abughazaleh — also known around the internet as "Kat Abu" — is taking an unconventional approach with her nascent political career. While Abughazaleh has made a name for herself nationally with TikTok videos and on podcasts by blasting veteran Democrats for allegedly sitting on their hands in the face of Donald Trump's presidency, she has thin connections to the district and its voters.

Turn to 9th District, Page 4



Downtown Dolton on Friday. Residents and officials hope the election of former Dolton resident Robert Prevost as pope could help bring businesses to the town, which is now the focus of attention in a way it has not been in the past. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Dolton hopes ties to new pope will burnish image, spur growth

Positivity welcomed after years marred by alleged corruption

By **Mike Nolan** and
Samantha Moilanen
Daily Southtown

Dolton residents and officials say they hope a hometown hero elected pope will go a long way toward reversing the village's tarnished image.

Dan Lee, a longtime Dolton resident, said Robert Francis Prevost, now Pope Leo XIV,

INSIDE

■ Pope's boyhood home in Dolton was on the market until Thursday. Now it's a unique landmark. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

■ South Holland church celebrates bragging rights as pope's de facto home parish. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

brings a newfound pride. Lee has lived in the community since 1989.

"This is a 180-degree turn from what we're used to," Lee said Friday. "I'm looking forward

to some positive scrutiny that this can bring."

The village has suffered after years of alleged corruption among village mayors past and more recently Tiffany Henyard, who was tossed out of office with the most recent election.

Lee said he believed the selection of Prevost as pope could help bring businesses to Dolton, which is now the focus of attention.

"It's not about anything crazy, it's totally positive," he said.

Edward "Ed" Steave, elected

Turn to Dolton, Page 2

'Substantial progress' in trade talks

US, China upbeat, but say more details will come out Monday

By **Jamey Keaten**,
Christopher Bodeen
and **Will Weissert**
Associated Press

GENEVA — The lead U.S. negotiator in trade talks with China cited "a great deal of productivity" in resolving differences between the world's leading economic powers after officials wrapped two days of bargaining in Switzerland after President Donald Trump's steep tariffs and Beijing's retaliation.

There was "substantial progress" in the weekend sessions, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said Sunday, offering scant details on exactly what negotiations entailed. He said details would come out Monday.

Bessent was more cautious in assessing the state of play than was his partner, Trade Representative Jamieson Greer.

"It's important to understand how quickly we were able to come to agreement, which reflects that perhaps the differences were not so large as far as maybe thought," said Greer, who did not say what deal he was referring to.

Greer also said after the talks that the U.S. tariffs were a response to unbalanced trade between the countries, which the Trump administration views as a national

Turn to Trade, Page 9

